

1.9 STATUS IN WALES AND NORTHERN IRELAND

This specification has been approved by ACCAC for use by Centres in Wales and by CCEA for use by Centres in Northern Ireland.

Candidates in Wales and Northern Ireland should not be disadvantaged by terms, legislation or aspects of government that are different from those in England. Where such situations might occur, including in the external assessment, the terms used have been selected as neutral, so that candidates may apply whatever is appropriate to their own situation.

OCR will provide specifications, assessments and supporting documentation only in English.

Further information on the provision of assessment materials in Welsh and Irish may be obtained from the Information Bureau at OCR (telephone 01223 553998).

2 Specification Aims

The aims below set out the educational purposes of the GCSE specification for Economics. Many of these are reflected in the Assessment Criteria for the specification; others are reflected in the assessment of Key Skills. The specification provides candidates with opportunities to develop knowledge and understanding of market and non-market solutions to economic problems and an appreciation of the interdependence and dynamics of economic behaviour.

A course based on this specification should enable candidates to:

- make effective use of relevant terminology, concepts and methods and recognise the strengths and weaknesses of ideas used;
- apply knowledge and critical understanding to current issues and problems in a wide range of appropriate contexts;
- distinguish between facts and opinions and evaluate quantitative and qualitative data in order to help build arguments and make informed judgements;
- appreciate the perspectives of a range of stakeholders in relation to the environment, individuals, society, government and enterprise;
- develop key skills of numeracy, literacy, information and communication technology, working with others, improving own learning and performance and problem solving.

3 Assessment Objectives

Candidates should be able to:

- AO1 Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the specified subject content.
- AO2 Apply knowledge and understanding using appropriate terms, concepts, theories and methods effectively to address problems and issues.
- AO3 Select, organise, interpret and use information from various sources to analyse problems and issues.
- AO4 Evaluate evidence, make reasoned judgements and present conclusions accurately and appropriately.

4 Scheme of Assessment
